

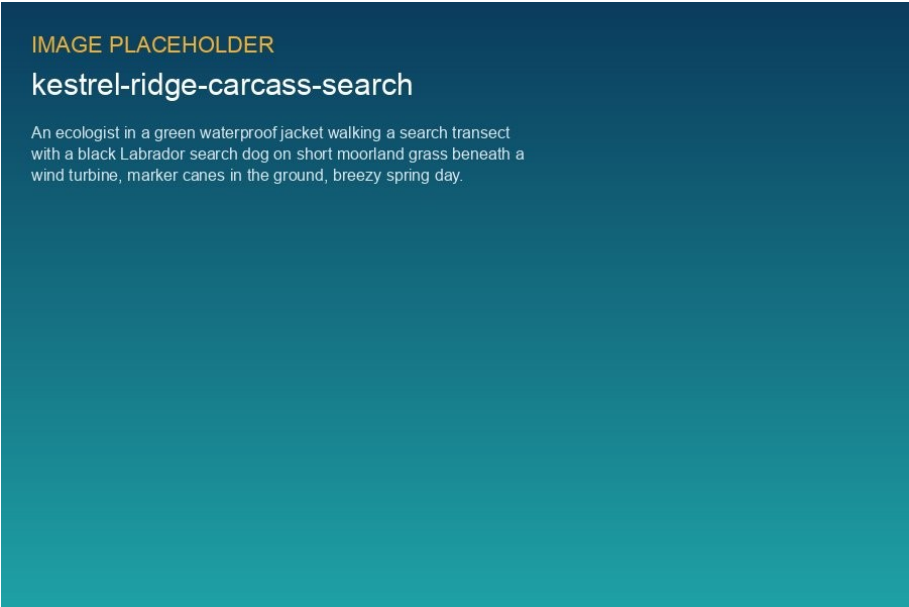
Post-Construction Bird and Bat Carcass Monitoring – Year 2 (2025)

Kestrel Ridge Wind Farm · prepared by Marlow Ecology Ltd

David Chen · 10 March 2026 · KR-ENV-RPT-2025-01

Summary

This report presents the second year of post-construction carcass monitoring at Kestrel Ridge, as required by planning condition 21. Searches were carried out fortnightly from March to November 2025 at all 18 turbines within a 100 m radius, using a trained search dog. Eight carcasses were found (seven birds, one bat). After correction for searcher efficiency and carcass persistence, the estimated annual mortality is **1.9 birds per turbine per year** (95 % CI 1.1–3.2), within the range predicted in the Environmental Statement (up to 2.5).



Dog-assisted carcass search at T-12, April 2025

1. Method

- 20 search rounds, 18 turbines, 100 m radius, transects 10 m apart
- Search dog 'Bramble' with handler; searcher efficiency trials with 40 dummy carcasses (efficiency 87 %)
- Carcass persistence trials with 30 carcasses (mean persistence 6.4 days)
- Fatality estimator: Huso (2011) with 2025 trial parameters

2. Results

Date	Turbine	Species	Condition	Distance to tower
2025-03-11	T-02	Meadow pipit	Feather spot	38 m
2025-04-22	T-09	Common gull	Intact carcass	61 m
2025-05-06	T-14	Meadow pipit	Partial carcass	22 m
2025-06-17	T-05	Swift	Intact carcass	47 m

2025-07-29	T-11	Black-headed gull	Partial carcass	73 m
2025-09-09	T-14	Red kite	Intact carcass	54 m
2025-10-14	T-17	Woodcock	Intact carcass	29 m
2025-11-25	T-08	Common pipistrelle (bat)	Intact carcass	12 m

The red kite found under T-14 on 9 September 2025 is the only find of a species of conservation concern. The bird was ringed; the ringing record shows it fledged in 2023 at a nest about 9 km to the south-east. The planning authority and NatureScot were informed on 12 September 2025. No golden eagle or hen harrier carcasses were found.

3. Comparison with year 1

Indicator	2024 (Apr–Nov)	2025 (Mar–Nov)
Carcasses found	6	8
Estimated mortality (birds/turbine/yr)	1.7	1.9
Species of conservation concern	0	1 (red kite)
Bat carcasses	2	1

4. Recommendations

- Continue monitoring in 2026 (year 3, final year under condition 21).
- Add a targeted red kite flight activity survey around T-13 to T-15 in spring/summer 2026.
- Keep sheep grazing around turbine bases to maintain search efficiency.

Report prepared by Marlow Ecology Ltd, Bristol. Reviewed by Dr Rachel Moss, Principal Ecologist.